

# Multi-country outbreak of cholera



Epidemiological Update n. 38 published 30 June 2026

Cases – 114 829  
*Since Jan. 2026*

Deaths – 1 318  
*Since Jan. 2026*

Countries affected – 23  
*Since Jan. 2026*

Population at risk  
1 billion

Global risk –  
Very high

## In this edition:

- [Overview](#)
- [Global epidemiological update](#)
- [WHO regional overviews](#)
- [Focus on selected subregions and countries](#)

## Overview

### Data as of 31 May 2026

- In May 2026 (epidemiological weeks 19 to 22), a total of 29 610 new cholera and acute watery diarrhoea (AWD) cases were reported from 16 countries, territories, and areas (hereafter countries) across four WHO regions, showing a 43% increase from the previous month. The Eastern Mediterranean Region registered the highest number of cases, followed by the African Region, the South-East Asia Region, and the Region of the Americas. No cases were reported from the European Region or the Western Pacific Region. This period also saw 271 cholera-related deaths globally, representing a 30% increase from the previous month.
- Cholera cases and deaths in May 2026 were 59% and 61% lower than the same period last year (72 914 cases and 687 deaths across 21 countries).
- For the year so far, from 1 January to 31 May 2026, a total of 114 829 cholera and AWD cases and 1318 deaths were reported from 23 countries across four WHO regions, with the African Region recording the highest number of cases, followed by the Eastern Mediterranean Region, the Region of the Americas and the South-East Asia Region. No cases were reported from the European Region or the Western Pacific Region during this time.
- In recent years, conflict, mass displacement, disasters associated with natural hazards, and climate-related events have contributed to conditions that may facilitate cholera transmission, particularly in rural and flood-affected areas, where poor infrastructure and limited access to healthcare can delay treatment. These cross-border factors have made cholera outbreaks increasingly complex and harder to control.
- The data presented here should be interpreted with caution. Potential underreporting and reporting delays may affect timeliness and accuracy, while variations in surveillance systems, standard case definitions, and laboratory capacities can limit direct comparability among countries. These factors also influence the global case fatality rate (CFR), requiring careful examination. Unless otherwise specified, the term 'cholera cases' includes both suspected and confirmed cases. Data in this report may be adjusted retrospectively as more information becomes available. For the latest data, please refer to the [WHO Global Cholera and AWD Dashboard](#).
- Starting in July, the cholera epidemiological update will be included on a monthly basis in the Weekly Epidemiological Record (WER), providing readers with regular consolidated information on the global cholera situation and key epidemiological trends. The update will be accessible through the WHO WER platform: [The Weekly Epidemiological Record \(WER\)](#).

# Global epidemiological update

In May 2026 (epidemiological weeks 19 to 22), a total of 29 610 new cholera and acute watery diarrhoea (AWD) cases were reported from 16 countries across four WHO regions, representing a 43% increase from the previous month and a 59% decrease compared with the same period last year (72 914 cases across 21 countries).

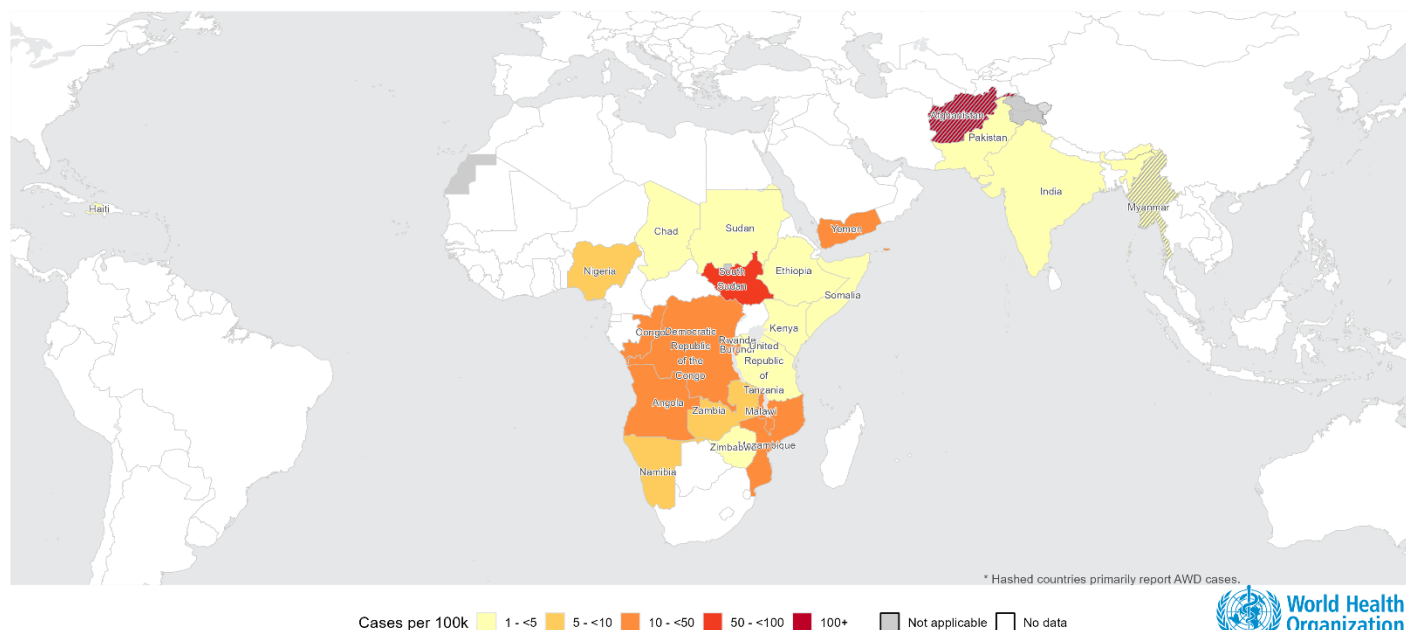
In May 2026, the Eastern Mediterranean Region (15 312 cases; four countries) reported the highest number of cases, followed by the African Region (14 230 cases; 10 countries), the South-East Asia Region (54 cases; one country), and the Region of the Americas (14 cases; one country). No cases were reported from the European Region or the Western Pacific Region.

During the same period, 271 cholera-related deaths were reported globally, representing a 30% increase compared with the previous month. In May 2026, the highest number of deaths was recorded in the African Region (201 deaths; seven countries), followed by the Eastern Mediterranean Region (70 deaths; three countries). No deaths were reported from the Region of the Americas, the South-East Asia Region, the European Region or the Western Pacific Region.

From 1 January to 31 May 2026, a cumulative total of 114 829 cholera and AWD cases and 1318 deaths were reported from 23 countries across four WHO regions. The region with the highest reported case count was the African Region (61 888 cases; 16 countries), followed by the Eastern Mediterranean Region (52 171 cases; five countries), the Region of the Americas (529 cases; one country), and the South-East Asia Region (241 cases; two countries). No cases were reported from the European Region or the Western Pacific Region during this period.

During the same period, cholera deaths were reported in the African Region (1230 deaths), the Eastern Mediterranean Region (86 deaths), and the Region of the Americas (two deaths). No deaths were reported from the South-East Asia Region, the European Region or the Western Pacific Region.

**Figure 1. Cholera and acute watery diarrhoea (AWD) cases per 100 000, 1 January to 31 May 2026**



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Data Source: World Health Organization  
Map Production: WHO Health Emergencies Programme  
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**Table 1. Reported cholera and AWD cases and deaths by WHO Region, as of 31 May 2026**

| WHO Region                   | Country, territory, area         | 1 January to 31 May 2026 |        |         |                   | Last 28 days |        |         |                        |                         |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------|--------|---------|-------------------|--------------|--------|---------|------------------------|-------------------------|
|                              |                                  | Cases                    | Deaths | CFR (%) | Cases per 100 000 | Cases        | Deaths | CFR (%) | Monthly cases % change | Monthly deaths % change |
| African Region               | Angola                           | 4 852                    | 96     | 2.0     | 13                | 1 742        | 34     | 2.0     | -23                    | -13                     |
|                              | Burundi                          | 1 163                    | 2      | 0.2     | 9                 | 189          | 0      | 0.0     | -45                    | -                       |
|                              | Congo                            | 651                      | 34     | 5.2     | 11                | 266          | 13     | 4.9     | 122                    | 18                      |
|                              | Democratic Republic of the Congo | 28 567                   | 815    | 2.9     | 24                | 3 651        | 82     | 2.2     | -18                    | -36                     |
|                              | Ethiopia                         | 50                       | 2      | 4.0     | 0                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Kenya                            | 26                       | 0      | 0.0     | 0                 | 26           | 0      | 0.0     | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Malawi                           | 3 088                    | 30     | 1.0     | 18                | 732          | 2      | 0.3     | -22                    | -82                     |
|                              | Mozambique                       | 7 500                    | 66     | 0.9     | 26                | 231          | 2      | 0.9     | -49                    | 100                     |
|                              | Namibia                          | 213                      | 0      | 0.0     | 7                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Nigeria                          | 6 860                    | 80     | 1.2     | 3                 | 5 798        | 54     | 0.9     | 15 158                 | -                       |
|                              | Rwanda                           | 58                       | 0      | 0.0     | 0                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | South Sudan                      | 7 712                    | 84     | 1.1     | 62                | 1 579        | 14     | 0.9     | 15                     | 75                      |
|                              | United Republic of Tanzania      | 113                      | 2      | 1.8     | 0                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Zambia                           | 999                      | 17     | 1.7     | 5                 | 16           | 0      | 0.0     | -92                    | -                       |
|                              | Zimbabwe                         | 36                       | 2      | 5.6     | 0                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
| Eastern Mediterranean Region | Afghanistan†                     | 43 292                   | 18     | <0.1    | 132               | 13 645       | 8      | 0.1     | 54                     | 100                     |
|                              | Pakistan§                        | 3 305                    | 0      | 0.0     | 1                 | 560          | 0      | 0.0     | -8                     | -                       |
|                              | Somalia                          | 233                      | 0      | 0.0     | 1                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Sudan                            | 527                      | 61     | 11.6    | 1                 | 518          | 61     | 11.8    | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Yemen¥                           | 4 814                    | 7      | 0.1     | 14                | 589          | 1      | 0.2     | -29                    | -50                     |
| Region of the Americas       | Haiti                            | 529                      | 2      | 0.4     | 5                 | 14           | 0      | 0.0     | -89                    | -                       |
| South-East Asia Region       | India#                           | 36                       | 0      | 0.0     | 0                 | -            | -      | -       | -                      | -                       |
|                              | Myanmar†                         | 205                      | 0      | 0.0     | 0                 | 54           | 0      | 0.0     | 980                    | -                       |

\* Percentage changes compare the period 4–31 May 2026 with 29 March–26 April 2026 (epidemiological weeks 14 to 17).

\*\* Case and death numbers presented are not directly comparable due to differences in case definitions, reporting systems, and general underreporting. All data are subject to verification and change due to data availability and accessibility. Respective figures and numbers will be updated as more information becomes available. The data in Table 1 includes suspected, rapid diagnostic test (RDT) positive, and culture-confirmed cholera cases. As multiple countries report only total data on deaths, the reported CFR is calculated throughout based on the total number of deaths reported. The Global Task Force on Cholera Control (GTFCC) recommends that CFR be calculated using only facility deaths, with the number of community deaths reported separately.

\*\*\* Missing data in this report do not imply the absence of cholera or AWD cases or deaths in the respective country. The data presented in this report are based on the latest available information and may not reflect the current situation.

† Afghanistan and Myanmar report AWD cases.

§ The reported number of suspected cholera and AWD cases is based on the available [Public Health Bulletin published by the National Institute of Health of Pakistan](#).

¥ Includes all reported suspected cholera and AWD cases from Yemen. From epidemiological week 18 of 2026, reported data is only from International Recognised Government (IRG) areas.

# Among the total of 36 cases reported from India, 27 cases were confirmed.

# WHO regional overviews

## African Region

In May 2026, the African Region reported 14 230 new cholera cases across 10 countries, marking a 39% increase compared with the previous month. During this period, the highest number of cases were reported from Nigeria (5798), the Democratic Republic of the Congo (3651), Angola (1742), and South Sudan (1579). Additionally, there were 201 cholera-related deaths. The highest number of deaths were reported from the Democratic Republic of the Congo (82), Nigeria (54), and Angola (34).

From 1 January 2026 to 31 May 2026, a total of 61 888 cholera cases were reported across 16 countries in the African Region. The highest number of cases were reported from the Democratic Republic of the Congo (28567), South Sudan (7712), and Mozambique (7500). During the same period, a total of 1230 deaths were reported from 12 countries: The highest number of deaths were reported from the Democratic Republic of the Congo (815), Angola (96), and South Sudan (84).

## Eastern Mediterranean Region

In May 2026, the Eastern Mediterranean Region reported 15 312 new cholera and AWD cases across four countries, marking a 48% increase compared with the previous month. During this period, cases were reported from Afghanistan (13 645), Yemen (589), Pakistan (560), and Sudan (518). Additionally, there were 70 cholera-related deaths reported from Sudan (61), Afghanistan (8), and Yemen (1).

From 1 January 2026 to 31 May 2026, a total of 52 171 cholera and AWD cases were reported across five countries in the Eastern Mediterranean Region. The highest number of cases were reported from Afghanistan (43 292), Yemen (4814), and Pakistan (3305). During the same period, a total of 86 deaths were reported from three countries: Sudan (61), Afghanistan (18), and Yemen (seven deaths).

## Region of the Americas

In May 2026, the Region of the Americas reported 14 new cholera cases in Haiti, marking an 89% decrease compared with the previous month. No deaths were reported during this period.

From 1 January to 31 May 2026, a total of 529 cholera cases and two deaths were reported from Haiti.

## South-East Asia Region

In May 2026, the South-East Asia Region reported 54 new cholera or AWD cases, all from Myanmar, marking a 980% increase compared with the previous month. No deaths were reported during this period.

From 1 January to 31 May 2026, a total of 241 cholera or AWD cases were reported across 2 countries in the South-East Asia Region. Cases were reported from Myanmar (205) and India (36). No deaths were reported during this period.

Figure 2. Global cholera and AWD cases by week, 1 January 2024 to 31 May 2026

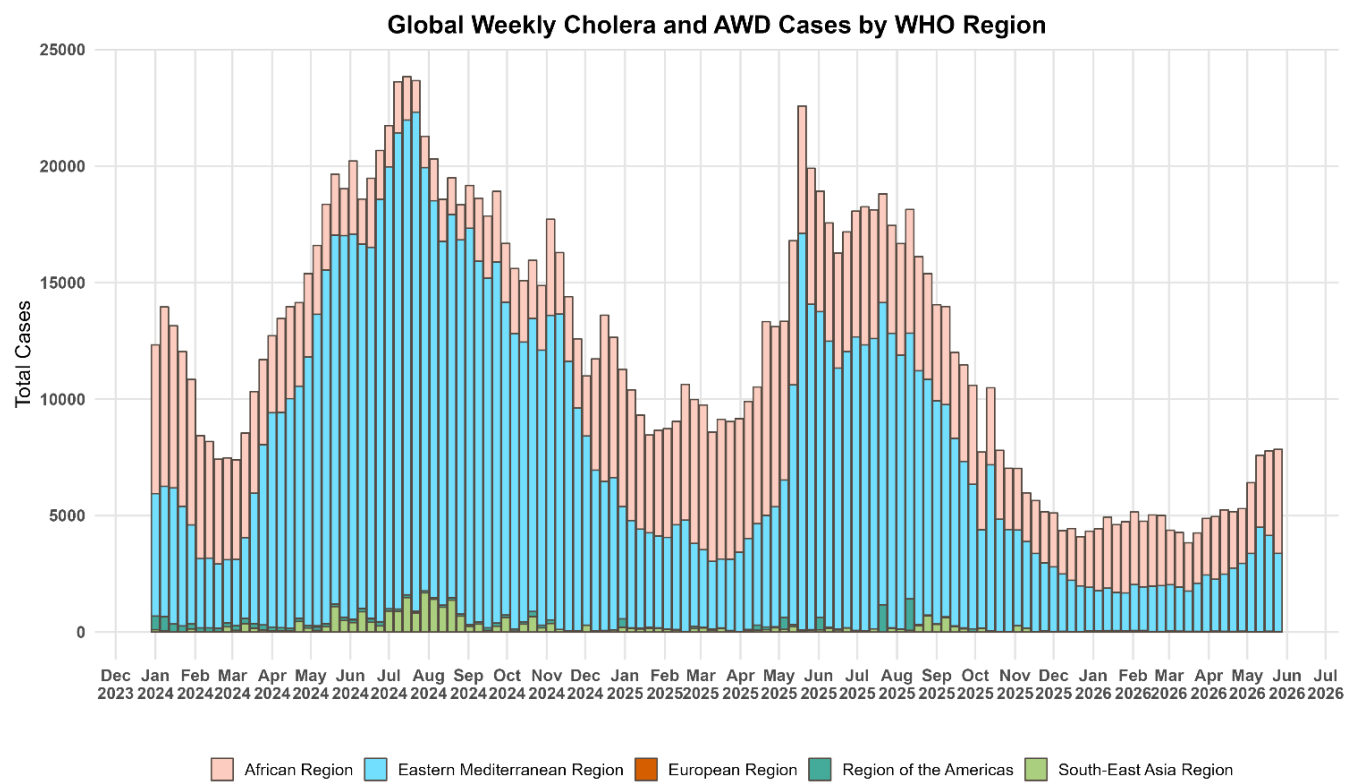
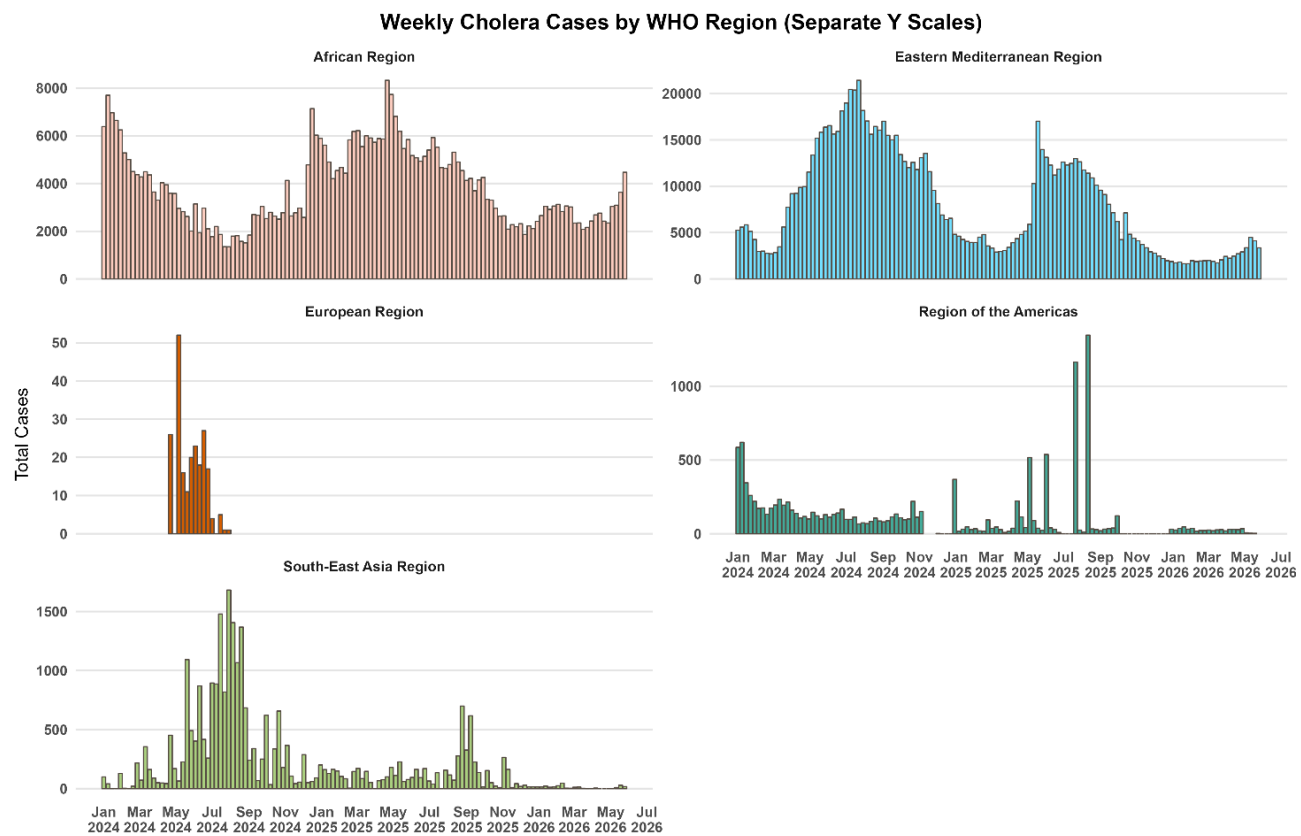


Figure 3. Cholera and AWD cases by WHO Region (separate Y scales), 1 January 2024 to 31 May 2026



\* The epi curve of the Western Pacific Region is not included due to limited available weekly data.  
\*\* Spikes in the Region of the Americas are due to batch reporting.

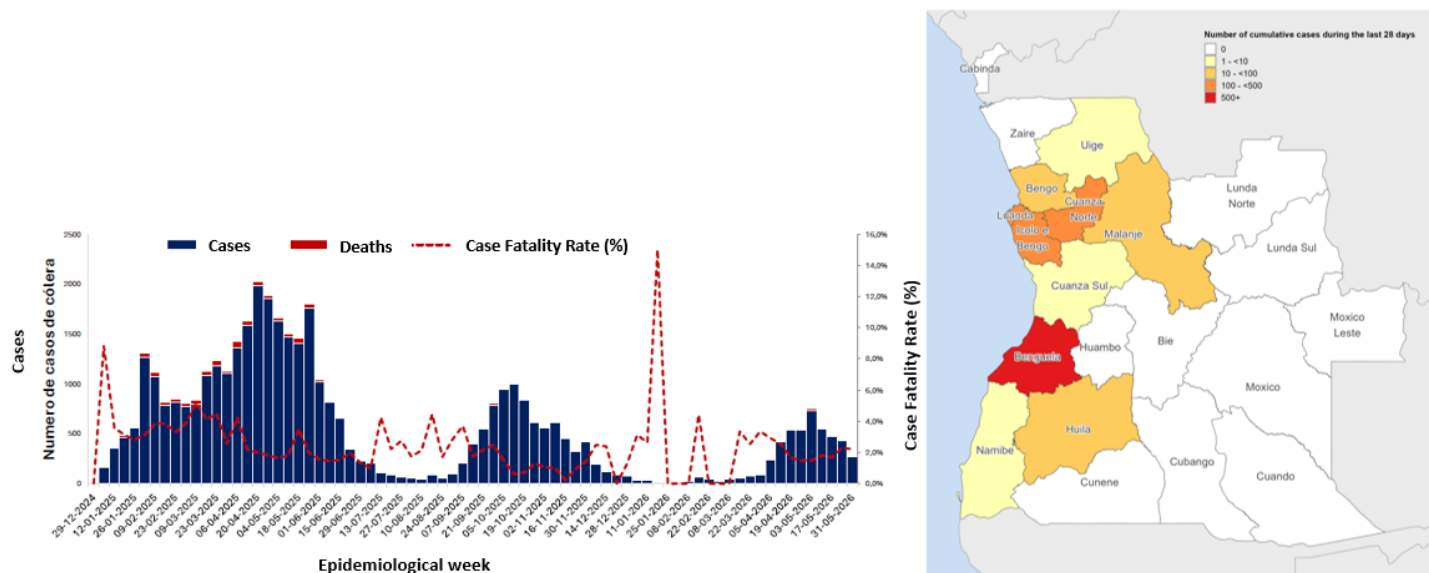
## Focus on selected subregions and countries

### Angola

Between 1 January and 31 May 2026, Angola reported a total of 4852 cases and 96 deaths (CFR: 2%).

In May 2026, Angola reported 1742 new cholera cases and 34 associated deaths (CFR: 2%). This represents a 23% decrease in cases and a 13% decrease in deaths compared with the previous month. The highest number of cases were reported in Benguela (42%), Luanda (17%) and Icolo e Bengo (13%).

**Figure 4:** Angola: weekly case trend (left) and distribution of cases by province in the last 28 days (right), as of 31 May 2026



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Data Source: World Health Organization,  
Ministry of Health Angola  
Map Production: WHO Health Emergencies Programme

 **World Health Organization**  
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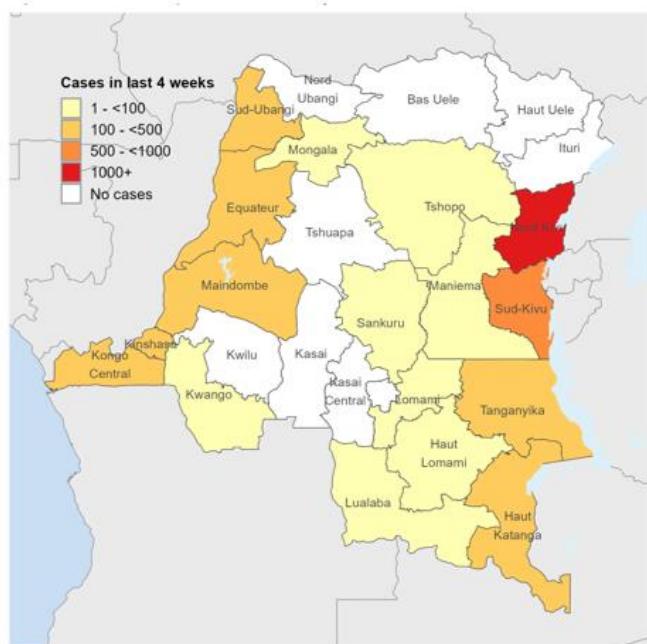
## Democratic Republic of the Congo

Between 1 January and 31 May 2026, the Democratic Republic of the Congo reported a total of 28 567 cases and 815 deaths (CFR: 2.9%).

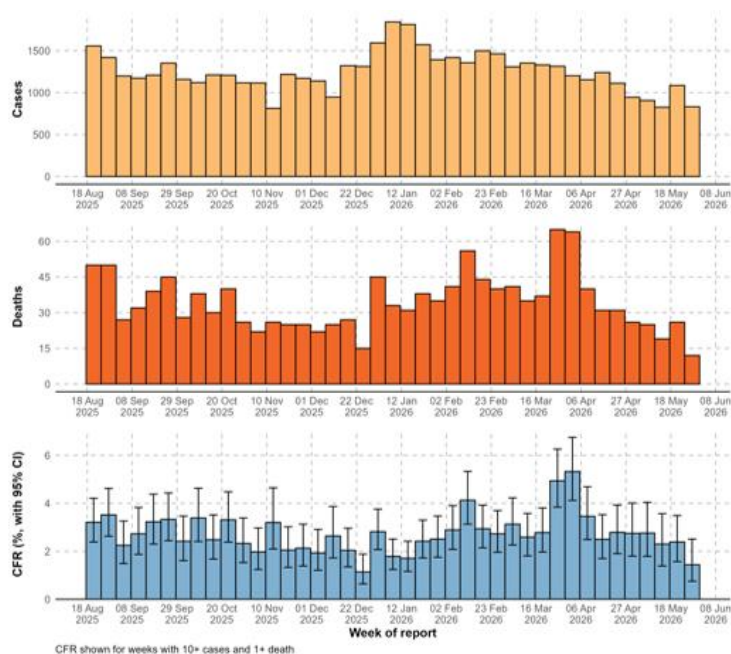
In May 2026, the Democratic Republic of the Congo reported 3651 new cholera cases and 82 associated deaths (CFR: 2.2%). This represents an 18% decrease in cases and a 36% decrease in deaths compared with the previous month. Overall, 17 out of 26 provinces have been affected with the highest proportions from Nord-Kivu (35%), Sud-Kivu (24%), and Kinshasa (8%).

High levels of transmission continue in the East, particularly in lakeside communities where access to safe water is insufficient and WASH conditions remain poor. Additional challenges include limited access to hotspot areas due to insecurity and conflict.

**Figure 5:** Democratic Republic of the Congo: Distribution of cases by province in the last four weeks (left) and weekly case, death and CFR trends (right), as of 31 May 2026



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Data Source: World Health Organization, Ministry of Health  
Democratic Republic of the Congo  
Map Production: World Health Organization

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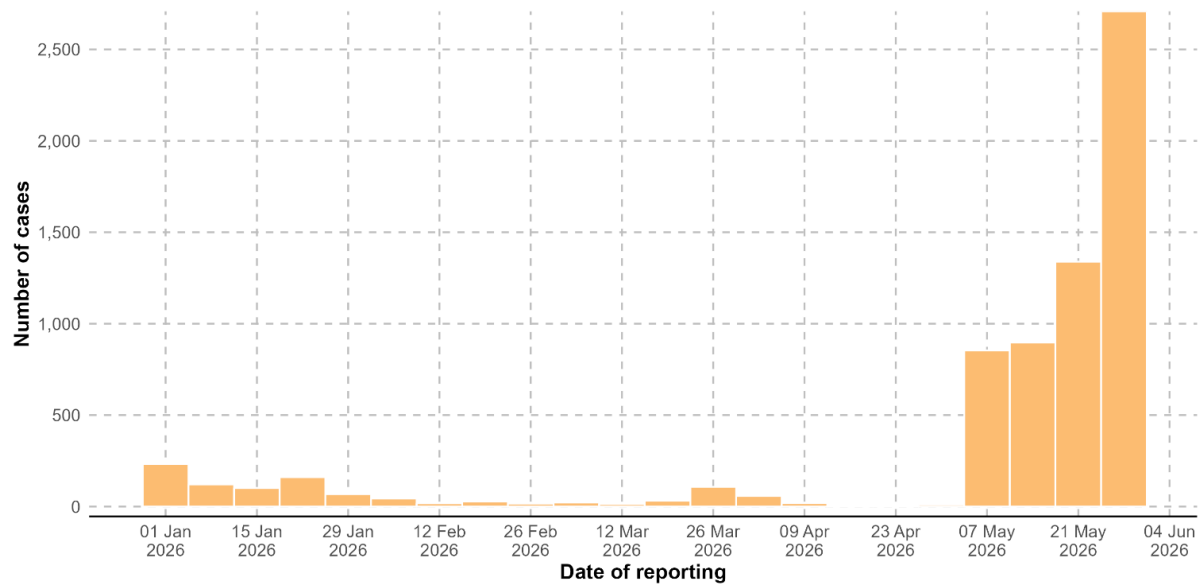
Nigeria

Between 1 January and 31 May 2026, Nigeria reported a total of 6860 cases and 80 deaths (CFR: 1.2%).

In May 2026, Nigeria reported 5798 new cholera cases and 54 associated deaths (CFR: 0.9%). This represents a 15 158% increase in cases compared with the previous month.

Borno State is driving the national outbreak, recording 5267 cumulative cases and 49 deaths (23 facility-based, 26 community; CFR 0.9%) from 1 to 31 May 2026 across 10 Local Government Areas (LGAs), with Maiduguri and Jere being the most affected LGAs. The overall CFR in both LGAs remains around the 1% threshold.

Figure 6: Nigeria: Weekly case trend, as of 31 May 2026





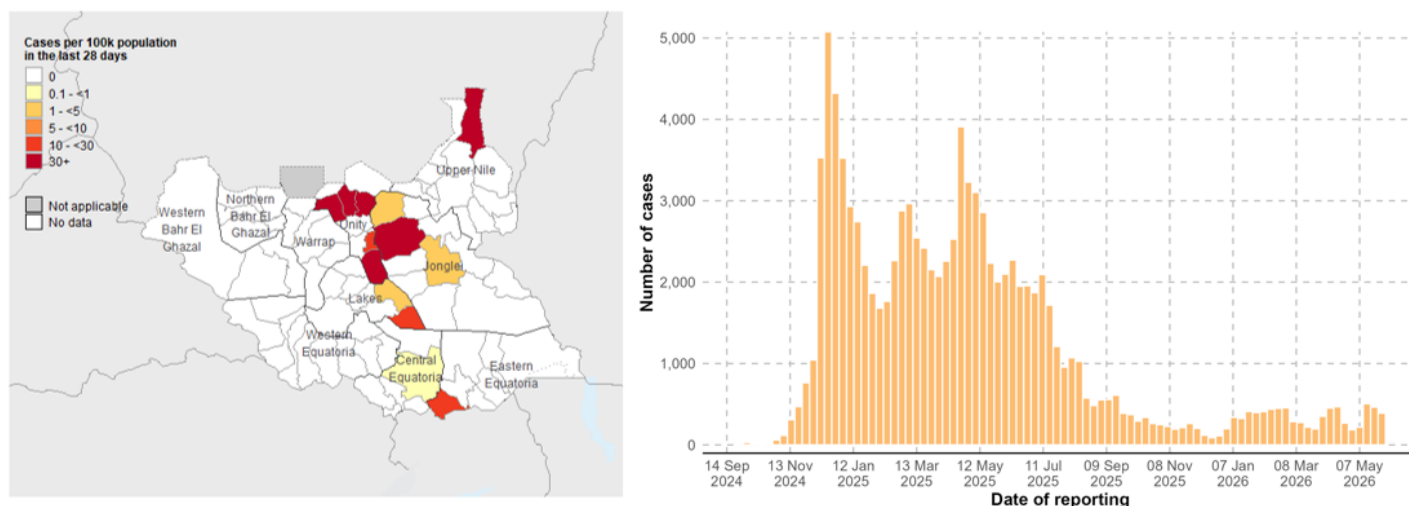
## South Sudan

Between 1 January and 31 May 2026, South Sudan reported a total of 7712 cases and 84 deaths (CFR: 1.1%).

In May 2026, South Sudan reported 1579 new cholera cases and 14 associated deaths (CFR: 0.9%). This represents a 15% increase in cases and a 75% increase in deaths compared with the previous month. The highest number of cases were reported in Unity (81%), followed by Jonglei (11%) and Upper Nile (5%) states.

Population displacement and conflict-related movement are likely contributing to the persistence and resurgence of cholera, particularly where water, sanitation, and hygiene conditions are inadequate in camps for internally displaced people. The security situation remains volatile, with Akobo in Jonglei State being the most critically affected county due to ongoing insecurity, conflict, and civilian displacement.

**Figure 7:** South Sudan: Distribution of cases per 100 000 population by county in the last 28 days (left) and weekly case trend (right), as of 31 May 2026



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Data Source: World Health Organization, Federal Ministry of Health South Sudan  
Map Production: World Health Organization

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## Annex 1. Data, table, and figure notes

Caution must be taken when interpreting all data presented. Differences are to be expected between information products published by WHO, national public health authorities, and other sources using different inclusion criteria and different data cut-off times. While steps are taken to ensure accuracy and reliability, all data are subject to continuous verification and change. Case definitions, laboratory testing strategies, reporting practices, and lag times differ across countries/territories/areas. These factors, among others, influence the counts presented, with variable underestimation of the true case and death counts, and variable delays in reflecting these data at the global level.

'Countries' may refer to countries, territories, areas, or other jurisdictions of similar status. The designations employed, and the presentation of these materials do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of WHO concerning the legal status of any country, territory, or area or of its authorities, or concerning the delimitation of its frontiers or boundaries. Dotted and dashed lines on maps represent approximate border lines for which there may not yet be full agreement. Countries, territories, and areas are arranged under the administering WHO region. The mention of specific companies or of certain manufacturers' products does not imply that they are endorsed or recommended by WHO in preference to others of a similar nature that are not mentioned. Errors and omissions excepted; the names of proprietary products are distinguished by initial capital letters.

## Annex 2. Technical guidance and other resources

### General

- [Cholera fact sheet](#)
- [Ending Cholera: A Global Roadmap to 2030](#)
- [Global cholera strategic preparedness, readiness, and response plan 2023/24](#)
- [WHO's Call for urgent and collective action to fight cholera](#)
- [Disease outbreak news Cholera – Multi-country with a focus on countries experiencing current surges](#)
- [Global Task Force on Cholera Control \(GTFCC\)](#)
- [AFRO Weekly outbreaks and emergency bulletin](#)
- [WHO Global Cholera and AWD Dashboard](#)
- [WHO AFRO Cholera Dashboard](#)
- [Cholera upsurge \(2021-present\) web page](#)

### Training

- GTFCC Laboratory training on [Sample collection and testing with Rapid Diagnostic Tests for cholera for health care workers](#) available in English, French, Arabic, and Portuguese.
- GTFCC Laboratory [job aids and fact sheets](#) available in English, French, Arabic, and Portuguese.
- [GTFCC Cholera surveillance for health care workers](#). These courses are available in English and French.
- [GTFCC Cholera surveillance for health authorities](#). This course is available in English and French.
- Countries are encouraged to periodically self-assess their cholera surveillance systems using the [GTFCC surveillance assessment method](#) to identify priority activities for strengthening surveillance in line with GTFCC recommendations.

### Technical guidance

- [GTFCC fixed ORP interim guidance and planning](#).
- [Public health surveillance for cholera, Guidance document \(2024\)](#), including tools and job aids. These recommendations are available in English, French, Arabic, and Portuguese.
- GTFCC [updated recommendations for cholera reporting to the regional and global levels](#), accompanied by an Excel [reporting template](#), are available in English, French, Arabic, and Portuguese.